

Kornelia Kunstmann

Executive Leader (35 FTE) · Program Management & Operational Excellence · Dipl.-Ing. Aerospace Engineering

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Application for: Director, Project Management & Operational Excellence, EMEA · Johnson Controls, Neuhausen

PROFILE

Executive leader and aerospace engineer with ~20 years across DLR, ESA, maxon and RUAG. I have led an organisation of up to 35 FTE, run complex customer projects end to end, and driven process management, digital transformation and change programmes. I bring structured project governance, standardised processes and KPI-driven continuous improvement, and work in German, English, French and Spanish across international teams.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head Documentation 02/2024 – 06/2026

RUAG AG · Emmen, Switzerland

- Led the documentation organisation of up to 35 FTE, with budget, resource and people responsibility
- Steered technical documentation in a regulated aerospace and defence environment
- Drove change management, process standardisation and operational excellence across the organisation

Senior Business Development Manager 01/2022 – 01/2024

RUAG AG · Emmen, Switzerland

- Identified, developed and won new business with customers and partners
- Prepared proposals, led negotiations and built partnerships in defence and aviation

Lead Digital Transformation 01/2021 – 12/2021

RUAG AG · Emmen, Switzerland

- Led digitalisation initiatives and guided the organisation through the change

Business Process Manager 06/2019 – 12/2020

RUAG AG · Emmen, Switzerland

- Analysed, modelled and improved end-to-end business processes

Space Science and Technology Advisor 04/2018 – 04/2019

Swiss Space Center · Zurich

- Advised on space science and technology; interface between industry, academia and public bodies

Research Associate / Aerospace Engineer 04/2017 – 03/2018

ETH Zurich / inspire AG · Zurich

- Research on additive manufacturing (3D printing) for space applications

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Operational Excellence & Continuous Improvement
- Project & Program Governance
- Process Standardisation
- Change Management
- Digital Transformation
- KPI & Risk Management
- People Leadership (35 FTE)
- Cross-functional Stakeholder Management

LANGUAGES

- German Native
- English Full professional (C1)
- French Professional working (B2)
- Spanish Professional working (B2)

TRAINING & CERTIFICATES

- Permaculture Design Certificate (PDC)
Permaculture Research Institute · 2021
- Claude 101 (AI fundamentals)
Anthropic

INTERESTS

- Regenerative design and permaculture, space and emerging technologies
- References available on request

Senior Project Manager

06/2011 – 03/2017

maxon motor group · Sachseln, Switzerland

- End-to-end responsibility for complex customer projects in precision drive systems, incl. aerospace
- Managed cost, schedule, quality and risk across cross-functional teams and suppliers

Technical Officer

02/2010 – 05/2011

European Space Agency (ESA)

- Technical oversight of space projects and industrial contracts

Development Engineer

09/2006 – 01/2010

German Aerospace Center (DLR)

- Design, analysis and testing of aerospace systems

EDUCATION

Dipl.-Ing. Aerospace Engineering

2000 – 2006

University of Stuttgart · Master's level (EQF 7)